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Primary Order Creating a Rift For Democrats

S. Carolina and Nevada Vie to Be First in 2028

By SHANE GOLDMACHER

South Carolina and Nevada have emerged as the two front-runners to begin the 2028 Democratic presidential nominating calendar, but their jockeying has grown acrimonious and pitted Black and Latino party leaders against each other, according to interviews with more than a dozen party officials involved in the discussions.

A powerful panel of 49 insiders of the Democratic National Committee is set to meet this week in Washington to sketch out the order of the early-state calendar. The full party body would then vote next month to finalize the choices.

The order of primary states is deeply consequential. Different states have different upsides and downsides for the party’s potential 2028 contenders — and require the constructing of different political coalitions. The calendar is likely to play a significant role in deciding who ultimately emerges as the next Democratic presidential nominee. And months of private lobbying, backroom discussions and brass-knuckle racial politics are bursting into the open on the eve of the gathering.

“It’s almost like we’re running against Nevada,” Christale Spain, the chair of the South Carolina Democratic Party, said in an interview. “That’s what it feels like.”

“If Nevada gets elevated over South Carolina, it would be because of their Latino vote,” added Ms. Spain, who is Black. “So you would then be telling Black voters that you matter less than brown voters. And I refuse to believe that our party wants to send any type of message like that.”

Other new states are jockeying to jump into the influential early window, including Virginia, which also has a sizable Black population.

“If you have the right calendar, you can have the right nominee to prepare you for the general election,” said Terry McAuliffe, a former Virginia governor and D.N.C. chair.

For decades, the nominating calendar for both Democrats and Republicans had begun in Iowa and New Hampshire, two overwhelmingly white states. But former President Joseph R. Biden Jr. put South Carolina — whose many Black voters helped make him the nominee in 2020 — first in 2024.

Now South Carolina is fighting to keep its premier slot. At the same time, Nevada argues that its status as a diverse and growing battleground state — with a large Latino population and a strong tradition of organized labor — would better position Democrats to win the general election. Nevada is a swing state that Democrats have won in recent years — they currently hold both of its Senate seats — while South Carolina is reliably Republican both in presidential years and at the state level.

Prominent Latino leaders and groups have been instrumental in

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KENNY HOLSTON/THE NEW YORK TIMES

‘Unimaginable Loss’
Sgt. Angel Rampersad of Queens was honored in Delaware, along with three other U.S. soldiers killed in the war with Iran. Page A7.

Fight to Rid South Africa of African Immigrants

Activists Take the Law Into Own Hands as Migration Rises

**By JOHN ELIGON
and ZIMASA MATIWANE**

JOHANNESBURG — On a clear morning last October, Nozie Khoza and her brigade of self-proclaimed patriots stood at the entrance of a public health clinic in Johannesburg on a quest to shape South Africa in their image.

When the gate opened at 7:30, the group demanded to see IDs from everyone seeking to enter, saying that only South Africans would be allowed inside.

“You belong to Nigeria, sweet-heart,” Bongzi Nomnganga, one of Ms. Khoza’s allies, told a young woman, turning her away because, even though she had a South African ID, her last name was Nigerian.

“It smells like fraud,” another one of Ms. Khoza’s associates said of a young woman’s South African ID, after the woman told them her parents were from Mozambique.

Ms. Khoza, a 39-year-old mother of two, had no authority to determine who could enter the public clinic.

Rather, she is a foot soldier in a highly organized network of activists going to extreme lengths to harass immigrants in South Africa, most of whom come from other

African nations in search of opportunity in the continent’s largest economy.

Polls show a growing number of South Africans share hostility toward immigrants and want the government to do more to thwart the heavy flow of migrants entering the country. There have been nationwide protests and violence. Immigrants have been attacked and even killed, chased from their homes and businesses.

Despite a lack of evidence, many South Africans blame immigrants for crime, for stealing jobs and for taking up valuable public resources in a nation with high unemployment and growing inequality. They say they have lost faith in the government and have

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Big Businesses Quietly Desert Climate Goals

By DAVID GELLES

Not so long ago, many of America’s biggest companies were making bold promises about saving the planet.

They pledged to stop polluting, get off fossil fuels and use recyclable materials. Some even promised to reinvent their core business practices, speaking aspirationally about a new, more sustainable economy.

These goals were set, and trumpeted, by the companies making the phone in your pocket, the shoes on your feet and the food in your fridge — and others. Coca-Cola, a company that produces as much plastic trash as any in the world, even began talking about “a world without waste.”

Over the past few years, however, many of these environmental commitments have evaporated.

Some companies have changed the way they measure progress. Others postponed their deadlines for making change. One company said its customers simply didn’t care about the issue anymore.

Under President Biden, there was extraordinary pressure for big business to address climate change. The Trump administration is now pushing companies to abandon climate goals and encouraging the use of more oil, gas and coal, claiming that environmental initiatives are “woke” distractions that hamper economic growth.

But the waning climate ambition across corporate America often has an even simpler explanation: Many companies have concluded it is simply too difficult and

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JOAO SILVA/THE NEW YORK TIMES

Sandra, a legal resident from the Democratic Republic of Congo, was forced from her home.

THE WEATHER
Today, mostly sunny, less humid, high 80. Tonight, clear, light winds, low 65. Tomorrow, mostly sunny early, partly sunny afternoon, high 82. Weather map is on Page B10.

U.S. EASES RULES IN NUCLEAR DEAL FOR SAUDI ARABIA

MAY ENRICH OWN FUEL

**Lawmakers and Israelis
Worry Pact Enables
Jump to Weapons**

**By DAVID E. SANGER
and WILLIAM J. BROAD**

President Trump went to war with Iran in part to force compliance with two longstanding American demands: Tehran must stop enriching nuclear fuel for at least two decades, and it must allow international inspectors to go anywhere and see anything to verify the country is not producing a bomb.

On Wednesday, Mr. Trump took the reverse approach to Saudi Arabia, its close ally in the region. To seal a deal for Westinghouse and other American companies to seize a big piece of the business in building two nuclear reactors on Saudi territory — and more to come — it opened the door to allowing the kingdom to begin enriching its own nuclear fuel after two years.

And it gave in to the kingdom’s demand that it not have to abide by an inspection agreement that applies to more than 140 other countries. Those rules, the Saudis said, are just too intrusive.

Now Mr. Trump will have to make the case to Congress, and to allies throughout the Middle East, that in loosening the nuclear standards for one close ally, he is not ushering in a new age of proliferation, especially in a region of the world already on fire.

If the daily missile exchanges with Iran finally give way to resumed negotiations, there is no question Iran will seize on the concessions made to Riyadh and insist on the same.

Already on Wednesday, administration officials were arguing that there was nothing to worry about, and that the United States will be so engaged in Saudi Arabia’s nuclear future that there is no way the kingdom could divert its nuclear fuel and know-how to a secret bomb program.

They may prove right. But nuclear history is littered with examples of countries that pledged to obey the rules, and surreptitiously raced for a bomb.

Iran’s first research reactor was provided by the United States to the shah of Iran, complete with weapons-grade uranium — technology that fell into the hands of

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KENNY HOLSTON/THE NEW YORK TIMES

A deal with the Saudi crown prince may limit inspectors.

Teen Pregnancy Program Loses Millions in Funds

By JAN HOFFMAN

A few weeks ago, Rena Dixon, the head of Fact Forward, a South Carolina nonprofit that offers adolescent health and sex education classes, got a letter from the Trump administration with crushing news. The government was terminating the organization’s \$1.6 million grant from a federal program to reduce teen pregnancies, effective immediately.

The administration’s priorities,

U.S. Pushes Agencies to Promote Abstinence

it said, do not align with “content that encourages, normalizes or promotes sexual activity for minors.”

The move is the latest in a campaign that began in the first Trump administration to defund or overhaul the 16-year-old, \$100

million initiative. Courts blocked the effort in 2018, but this time the administration, which abruptly canceled 53 of the program’s 67 grants last month, has been taking steps to be on firmer legal ground.

The letter from the assistant secretary for health accused Fact Forward of including lessons with “advice on making condom use more pleasurable” and discussions that normalize “use of

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Stymied on Netanyahu, Mamdani Takes to Video

*This article is by Sally Gold-
enberg, Dana Rubinstein and Liam
Stack.*

Mayor Zohran Mamdani recently disclosed that he was in “active conversation” with his legal team about whether he could make good on a campaign vow to arrest Benjamin Netanyahu, Israel’s prime minister, should he set foot in New York City.

What the mayor neglected to say, in a wide-ranging interview

Steering Clear of Tisch on Power to Arrest

with The New York Times last week, was that he had already been advised by lawyers that he had no authority to do so.

His declaration risked a rare public clash with his police commissioner, Jessica Tisch, whose pro-Israel stance runs counter to

the mayor’s longstanding position.

Ms. Tisch had no intention of arresting Mr. Netanyahu, and the Police Department was ready to make that clear with a formal statement declaring that it lacked the authority to take such action. Lawyers agreed that such an arrest was not within the scope of the Police Department.

“N.Y.P.D.’s position is entirely rooted in the law,” an agency

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NATIONAL A12-19

Strict Trans Bathroom Law
Lawmakers in Sandpoint, Idaho, used an encounter in a Y.M.C.A. locker room to rush through a law change. PAGE A12

Defense Bill Passes Despite Split
A \$1.15 trillion measure overcame House Democrats’ opposition to the Iran war, but its Senate path is murky. PAGE A14

INTERNATIONAL A4-11

A Lettuce Capital Is on Edge
In a region in central Mexico potentially linked to a cyclospora outbreak in the U.S. that has sickened thousands, people’s livelihoods are at stake. PAGE A5

New Military Chief Faces Test
Maj. Gen. Mykhailo Drapaty, commander of Ukraine’s armed forces, needs to balance a mandate for change with political input on strategy. PAGE A8

Louvre Gallery Reopens
Thieves stole crown jewels from the Apollo Gallery at the Paris museum in October, forcing its closure. Tourists finally returned on Wednesday. PAGE A9



THURSDAY STYLES D1-6

Her Own Way to Go Natural
Olivia Joan Galli, descended from pioneers in the field of Black hair care, has become a top fashion influencer. PAGE D6

Seattle Raccoon Is Online Hit
The unusual-looking animal reminds us, as one politician put it, “that you don’t have to be perfect to be loved.” PAGE D2

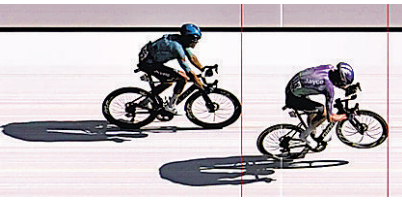
BUSINESS B1-5

An Economy Afloat on A.I.
Financial investment in artificial intelligence and its related companies is singlehandedly lifting the stock market and driving a surge of spending across the United States. PAGE B1

‘Vibecoding’ Floods App Store
Mobile apps are increasingly easy to make with the help of artificial intelligence, even by creators without technical knowledge. That doesn’t mean people are excited to use them. PAGE B1

OPINION A20-21

Thomas L. Friedman PAGE A20



SPORTS B6-10

Snap Decision at Finish Line
In each stage of the Tour de France, timekeepers in a tiny cabin packed with computers confirm the result almost instantly, even when it’s close. PAGE B8



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